

THARIQ HAMAD

Product & Operations Lead | EV Mobility & Battery-Swap Ecosystems

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SUMMARY

EV mobility and battery-swap ecosystem builder who took **Sri Lanka's first battery-swapping network** from a one-person startup to a **34-member operation** with a live B2B2C platform. Joined as **Employee #1** and built end-to-end command of the business **EV product, swap-station hardware design, fleet operations, and Energy-as-a-Service business models** while navigating vehicle import restrictions and regulatory barriers in a market with no existing playbook. Reduced **battery-swap time from 90 to 20 seconds**, cut **roadside incidents by 75%**, grew **daily rides per rider from 25 to 62**, and pioneered **Sri Lanka's first community-funded battery token program**. Now based in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, with a transferable Iqama, available immediately.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Product & Operations Lead - Employee #1

Sling Mobility (EV Mobility & Battery-Swap Network) | Sri Lanka

June 2021 - May 2024

Joined a one-person EV startup and built Sri Lanka's first battery-swapping ecosystem end-to-end product, hardware, operations, and business model through to a live B2B2C platform and a 34-person team.

FOUNDATION & LEADERSHIP

- Joined as the **first employee**, wearing multiple hats across technology and operations, and scaled the organization to a **34-member team**.
- Oversaw a **global product development team of 12** and managed all client, vendor, and partner communication, **reporting directly to the CEO and board**.
- Entered from an **IT background and self-built deep technical expertise** in EV electronics, electrical systems, motor torque dynamics, and IoT, the foundation for every product and hardware decision that followed.
- Navigated **vehicle import restrictions and regulatory barriers**, coordinating with government ministries, banks, and customs to bring EV bikes and batteries into the market.

PRODUCT & PLATFORM

- Launched Sri Lanka's **first electric two-wheeler last-mile delivery service**, building **last-mile delivery as a service** into a B2B2C offering alongside an electric bike sales vertical owning end-to-end product strategy and business operations across both.
- Designed user-centric **mobile app and web application UIs**, conducted user research and A/B testing across user flows, initiated development, and structured an **agile roadmap**.
- Launched **Sri Lanka's first battery-swapping ecosystem** station discovery, real-time battery tracking, and Google Maps navigation integration.
- Led A/B testing, UX optimization, and behavioral analysis through Google Analytics and Hotjar, **increasing app usage by 25%** and unlocking a new monetization stream.

BATTERY-SWAP INFRASTRUCTURE

- Designed the **physical battery-swap cabinet from first principles**, testing battery handling at multiple heights to determine the **optimal 4.5-foot configuration**, accounting for ventilation, heat dissipation, and ground clearance.
- Specified a **dual-control locking system** centrally managed from the command center and individually autonomous, working with the cabinet manufacturer on full electronic integration.
- Reduced **battery-swap time from 90 seconds to 20 seconds** across three iterations of process and IoT innovation, including an in-cabinet tablet application and **direct charger-to-database communication** via custom IoT devices and connectors.
- Integrated **CCTV and voice-command CCTV** across swap stations and built a **5-metre-radius location verification system** mapping rider position to cabinet location to prevent fraudulent battery access.

OPERATIONS & FLEET

- Prepared **SOPs for last-mile riders, bike servicing, and electronic unit maintenance** to standardize operations across the growing team.
- Built a **digital infrastructure tracking each bike's hardware components**, with automated alerts for scheduled bike and motor servicing.
- Conducted operational research into electricity usage, fuel consumption, vehicle wear-and-tear, and elevation challenges; established an **open-loop rider feedback system** enabling continuous issue detection, testing, and resolution.

BUSINESS MODEL & REVENUE

- Launched a **three-tier subscription model** (1,000 / 1,500 / 2,500 km per month) with a **two-month rolling-forward balance**, giving riders flexible, predictable access to battery energy.
- Designed and began building, with a local fintech partner, a **peer-to-peer kilometer marketplace** enabling subscribers to sell unused kilometers from their package to other riders, creating a secondary marketplace on top of the subscription base
- Launched **Sri Lanka's first battery token program** enabling individuals to own battery tokens, fund **100 new-generation batteries**, and earn automated revenue shares, structuring the business toward an **Energy-as-a-Service model**.
- Ideated **revenue-share battery-swap cabinets deployed across 10 roadside garages**, validated with low-income households.
- Implemented a rider incentive scheme that drove a **45% increase in monthly revenue** and built a real-time data feedback loop surfacing early-warning churn signals that drove a **30% increase in monthly recurring revenue**.
- Captured per-bike kilometer data to calculate carbon footprint and secured **carbon credits through a Singapore-based partner**, creating an additional revenue stream.

GROWTH, PARTNERSHIPS & EXPANSION

- Built a real-time in-app feature tracking travel distance, battery voltage, and nearest swap station, **reducing roadside assistance requests by 75%** and increasing rider trust in the system.
- Increased active ride counts **from 25 to 62 per day per rider** through navigation improvements and operational optimization.
- Negotiated a **commercial and technical product integration with Uber Sri Lanka**, broadening the platform's operational reach and distribution.
- Designed a **smart EV mobility roadmap for a university campus** and presented the same model to the **Maldivian government**.

PRIOR & CONCURRENT EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager, Fortude - AI & Enterprise SaaS (Infor M3 ERP).	October 2024 - January 2026
Co-Founder & Product Lead, FieldR - Sports Technology SaaS, co-founded and ran for six years.	June 2019 - May 2025
Project Manager, Motion Miracles - Fintech BNPL & mobile gaming.	December 2020 - June 2021
Project Manager, Win Authority Innovative - SaaS & web application delivery, US clients.	July 2018 - August 2020
Project Manager, MillenniumIT ESP - Banking-sector enterprise IT.	July 2017 - July 2018

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (BSc) in Information Systems with Business Management	
University of Westminster	2016 - 2019

CERTIFICATIONS

- Project Management Professional (PMP) - Ongoing
Project Management Institute
- Product Management First Steps Certificate
Project Management Institute
- Fundamentals of Digital Marketing Certificate
Google Digital Garage

SKILLS

- EV & Battery Systems:** Battery-Swap Infrastructure Design | Charge-Cycle Optimization | EV Electronics & Electrical Systems | IoT Integration | Command-Centre Operations | Fleet Telemetry
- Product & UX:** Product Strategy | Roadmap Ownership | Mobile & Web UI Design | User Research | A/B Testing | Agile Delivery | Behavioral Analytics
- Operations:** Fleet Operations | SOP Development | Vendor & Manufacturer Management | Maintenance Systems | Hardware Procurement | Regulatory & Import Navigation
- Business & Commercial:** Energy-as-a-Service Models | Revenue-Share Structures | Asset Tokenization | Carbon Credits | B2B2C Strategy | Partnership Negotiation
- Tools:** Figma | Jira | Confluence | Google Analytics | Hotjar | Firebase | Notion | SQL
- Languages:** English (Fluent) | Tamil (Native) | Arabic (Studying)